



Middle-class former Royal Marine charged over Liverpool parade horror

SEE PAGES 10 & 11



In court today: Paul Doyle, 53, is accused of offences including grievous bodily harm

KEMI BLASTS 'RACE TO THE BOTTOM' ON WELFARE HANDOUTS

EXCLUSIVE: Tory leader takes aim at Farage and Starmer for asking taxpayers to 'fund unlimited child support for others'

KEMI Badenoch has blasted Nigel Farage and Keir Starmer for being in a 'race to the bottom' over welfare handouts.

In a feisty attack on the Reform and Labour leaders, Mrs Baden-

By **Harriet Line**
Deputy Political Editor

och said the pair believed in getting taxpayers to fund 'unlimited child support for others' by scrapping the two-child benefit cap.

Writing in this newspaper, the Tory leader branded the benefit unfair and

unsustainable, because welfare 'traps people' and 'drives up costs for everyone'. Instead, she said the Conservatives were now the 'only serious party of sound money' and warned that Britain 'can't afford the fantasy economics of Starmer and Farage', who 'treat economics like a branch of showbiz'.

Mrs Badenoch's intervention

came after Mr Farage this week pledged a spending splurge of up to £85 billion - including generous benefit increases.

The Reform leader said his party would scrap the two-child benefit cap because 'it's the right thing to do', and would fully reverse the winter fuel

Turn to Page 6